Slides: https://magnusviri.com/saintcon2026

Dare I Call It Art?

magnusviri - James Reynolds, October 28, 2026

About magnusviri - James Reynolds

- U of U BMus 1999
- U of U Marriott Library, 14 years (Mac admin)
- U of U School of Biological Sciences/COS/LAS, 12 years (Mac, Linux, network admin)
- Security has been a “hobby” of mine for decades
- Since September 2022 (Stable Diffusion 1.0) I’ve been “obsessed with AI”
- https://magnusviri.com/saintcon2026





Agenda

- Invoke.ai
- What Is Art?
- Glossary
- Model Families
- Demo

Invoke.ai

Invoke.ai

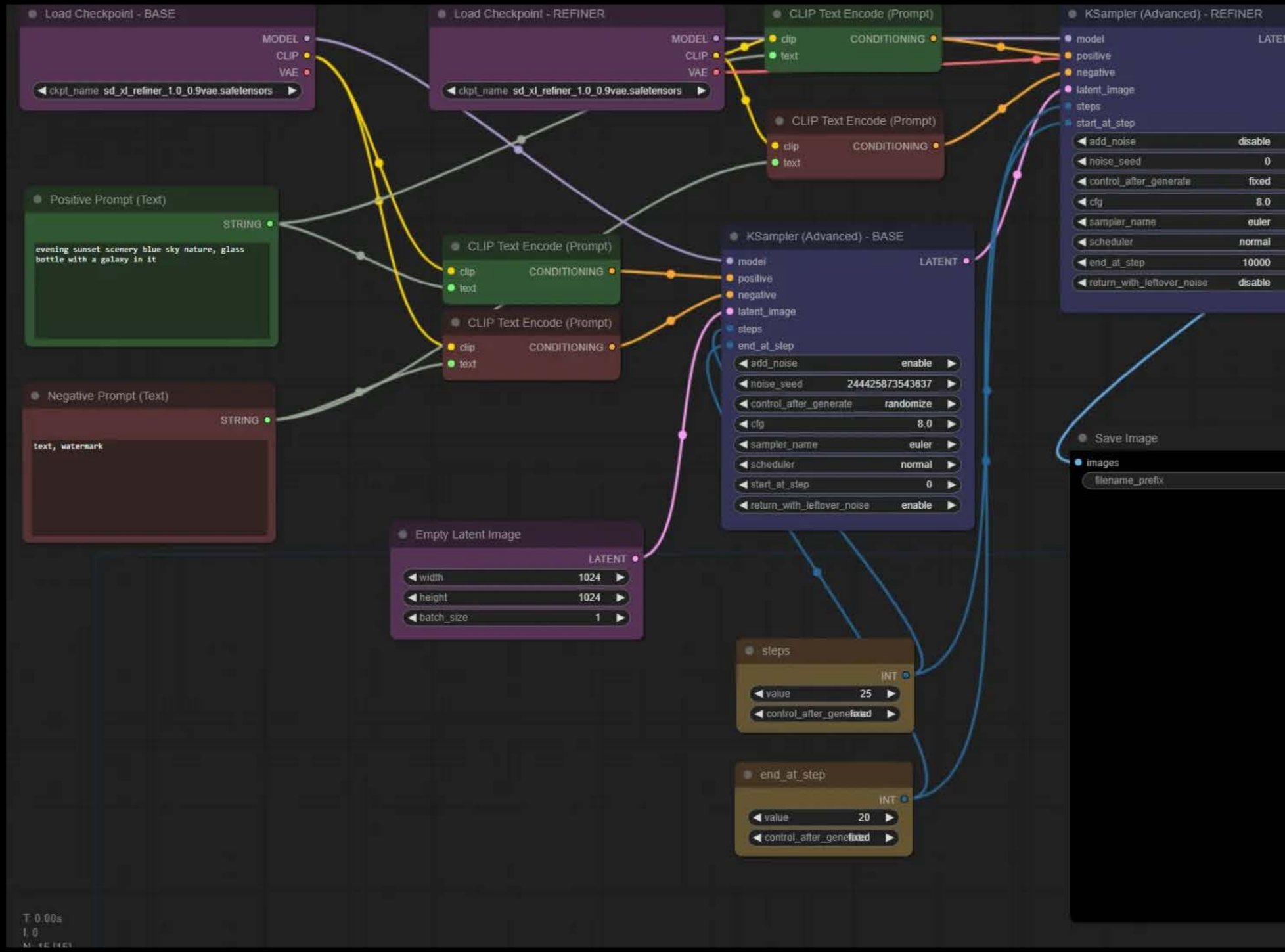


- Invoke started as a fork of the original Stable Diffusion 1.0 (Sept. 2022)
  - https://github.com/CompVis/stable-diffusion
  - One of the first with macOS support
- Invoke was less flexible than Automatic1111, but it always worked and only included legal components
- Invoke became a for profit company but then Adobe bought them last year
- Now they are a community group that is super active

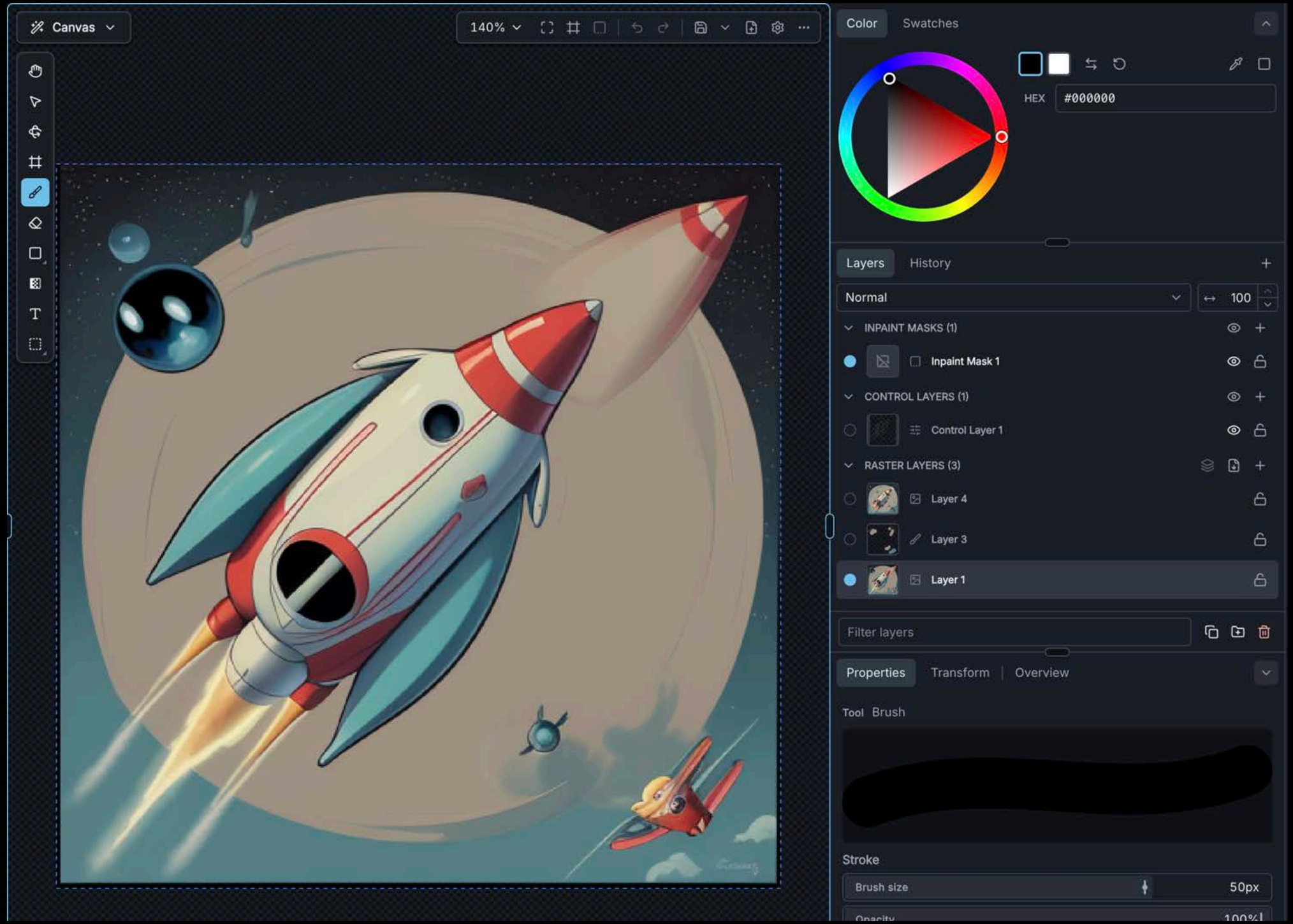
Why use Invoke instead of ComfyUI

- ComfyUI is a workflow app, the drawing tools are basic
- Invoke is meant for artists with drawing tablets
- Invoke also has workflows (they aren’t compatible with ComfyUI)

ComfyUI


Load Checkpoint - BASE
MODEL
CLIP
VAE
ckpt_name sd_xl_refiner_1.0_0.9vae.safetensors
Load Checkpoint - REFINER
MODEL
CLIP
VAE
ckpt_name sd_xl_refiner_1.0_0.9vae.safetensors
CLIP Text Encode (Prompt)
clip
text
CONDITIONING
CLIP Text Encode (Prompt)
clip
text
CONDITIONING
KSampler (Advanced) - REFINER
model
positive
negative
latent_image
steps
start_at_step
add_noise disable
noise_seed 0
control_after_generate fixed
cfg 8.0
sampler_name euler
scheduler normal
end_at_step 10000
return_with_leftover_noise disable
Positive Prompt (Text)
STRING
evening sunset scenery blue sky nature, glass bottle with a galaxy in it
CLIP Text Encode (Prompt)
clip
text
CONDITIONING
CLIP Text Encode (Prompt)
clip
text
CONDITIONING
KSampler (Advanced) - BASE
model
positive
negative
latent_image
steps
end_at_step
LATENT
add_noise enable
noise_seed 244425873543637
control_after_generate randomize
cfg 8.0
sampler_name euler
scheduler normal
start_at_step 0
return_with_leftover_noise enable
Negative Prompt (Text)
STRING
text, watermark
Empty Latent Image
LATENT
width 1024
height 1024
batch_size 1
Save Image
images
filename_prefix
steps
INT
value 25
control_after_generate fixed
end_at_step
INT
value 20
control_after_generate fixed
T: 0.00s
I: 0

Invoke


Canvas
140%
Color
Swatches
HEX
#000000
Layers
History
Normal
100
INPAINT MASKS (1)
Inpaint Mask 1
CONTROL LAYERS (1)
Control Layer 1
RASTER LAYERS (3)
Layer 4
Layer 3
Layer 1
Filter layers
Properties
Transform
Overview
Tool
Brush
Stroke
Brush size
50px

Installing

- Requires an M-series Mac or a GPU with 4+ GB or VRAM
- https://invoke.ai/start-here/installation/
- It takes a while to download and install everything
- Completely free and local (you can also use cloud models but they cost)
- Note, I’m demoing version 7.0.0-alpha.3
- Come to the AI village and try it on one of our computers

What Is Art?

This is art.

Will AI ever be able
to make this?

No



Young Astronomer
by Brian Kershisnik
https://kershisnikprints.com/products/young-astronomer-poster

Is this art?

Yes

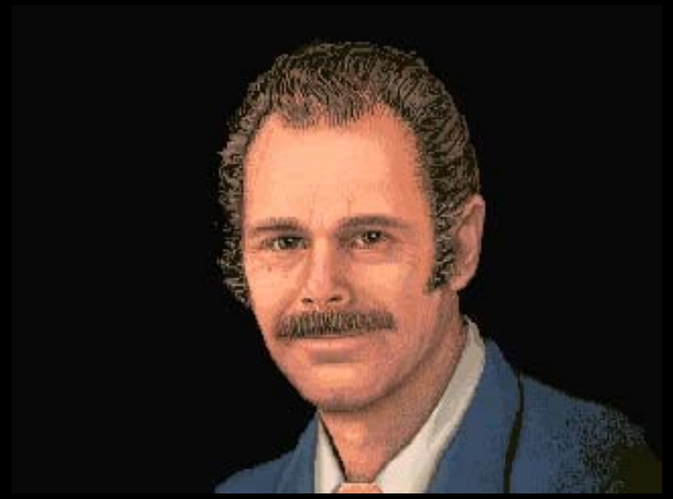
Is it art because of
how it was made?

Would it be art if
AI made it today?

Pixel art
(made on Amiga)
by James D. Sachs





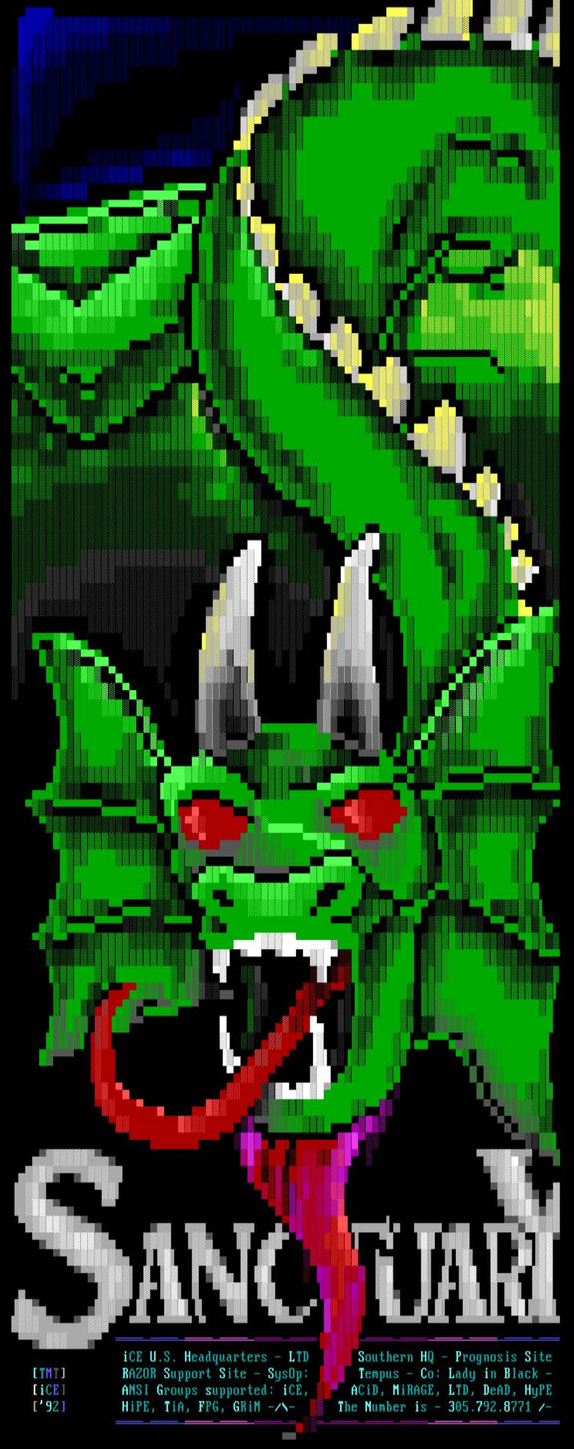




How about this?

Can AI make it?





ANSI Art, 1992
https://16colo.rs/pack/icepk-08/TMT-SANC.ICE

How about this?

Debbie Harry
(made on Amiga in 1985)
by Andy Warhol



“Andy, in his way, was very sociable and hung around with any-and everybody.”



Debbie Harry, https://news.artnet.com/art-world/debbie-harry-andy-warhol-1696761

Art is positive human connections

US Copyright Office Agrees

- Only humans can obtain copyright
- “Authoring” means having sufficient control over expressive elements
- Prompts do not constitute sufficient control

https://www.copyright.gov/ai/Copyright-and-Artificial-Intelligence-Part-2-Copyrightability-Report.pdf?pubDate=20250918

A Single Piece of American Cheese

- Kent Keirsey (ex-CEO of Invoke.ai) copyrighted this AI image in February 2025
- He did a lot more than just prompt
- USCO considers it like a collage

https://44037860.fs1.hubspotusercontent-na1.net/hubfs/44037860/Invoke-First-Copyright-Image-AI-Generated-Material-Report.pdf



The Social Contract

- The term “handmade” exists for a reason
- Please don’t distribute AI images and pass them off as handmade
- It’s lying
- It’s stealing
- Just don’t
- There is a lot of anti-AI image sentiment and this is why

Photoshop

- At first, Photoshop was an artistic sin
- AI *can be* a tool just like Photoshop
- My goal will be to show how to use AI image gen as a tool

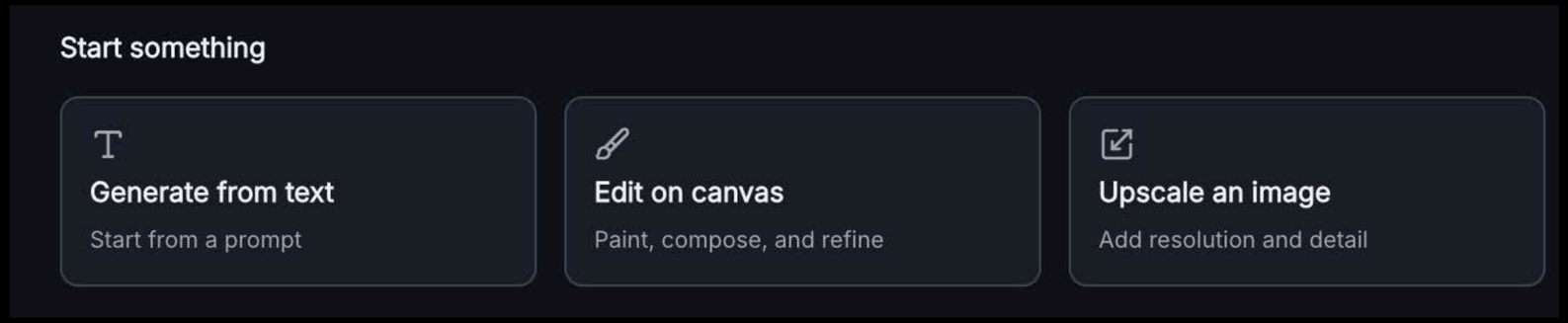
Glossary

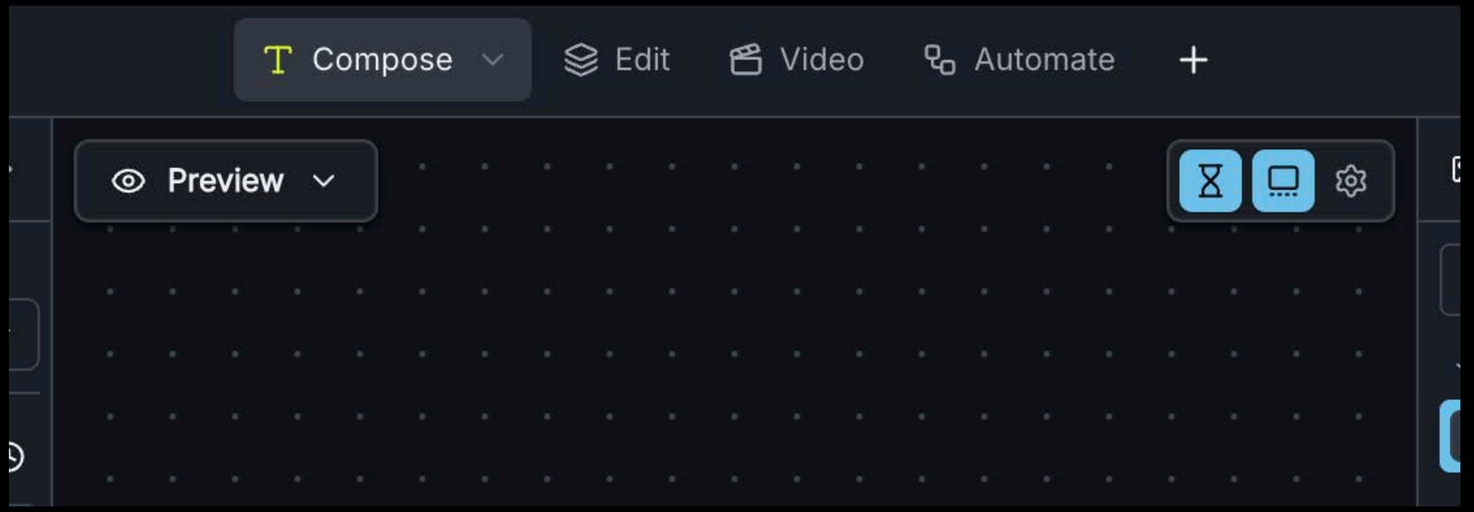
Glossary

- Text to Image
- Image to Image

  aka

  Inpainting/
  outpainting (Infill)





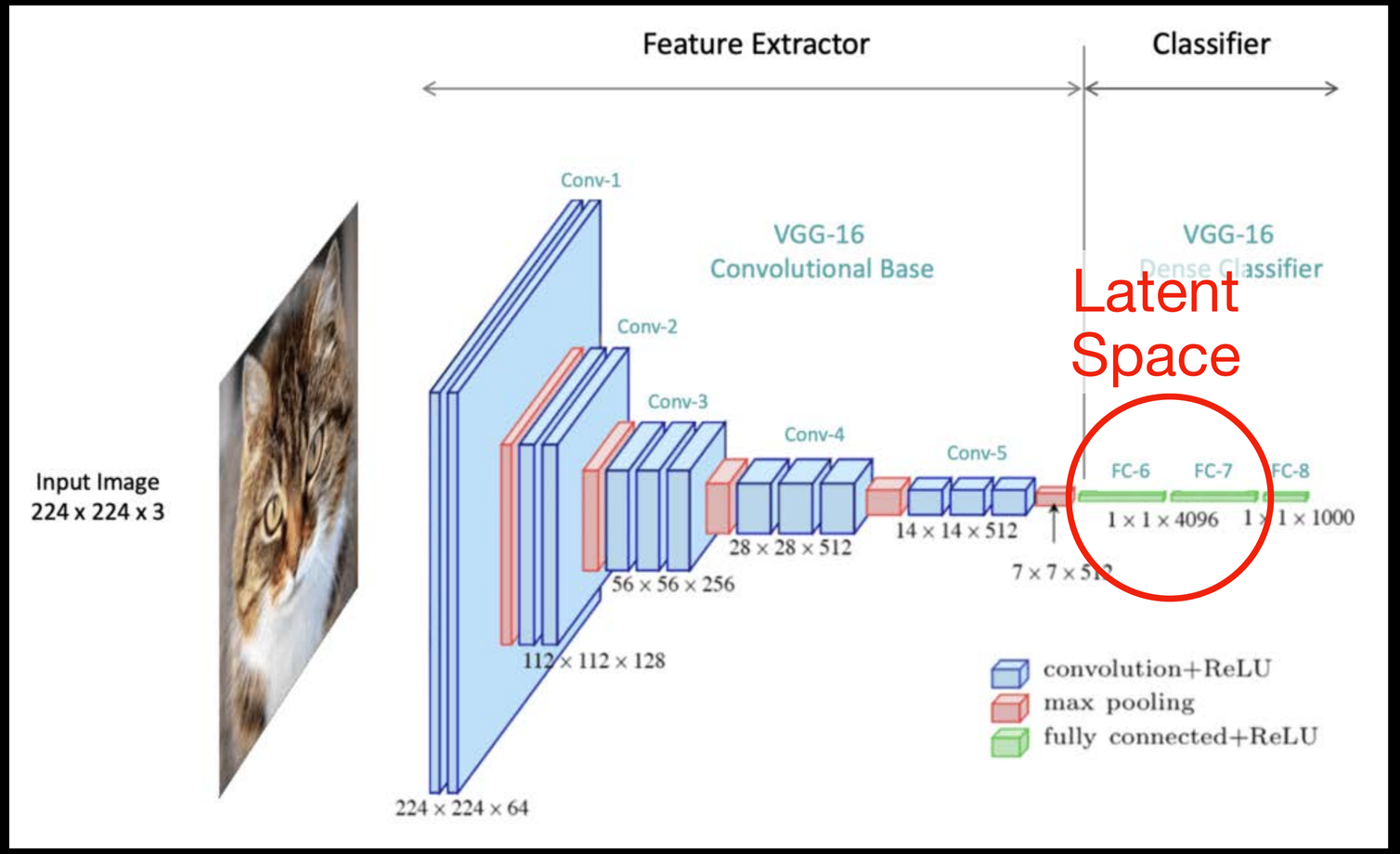
Glossary

- Model aka Checkpoint, the main trained model, aka base model
- Prompt
- Negative Prompt



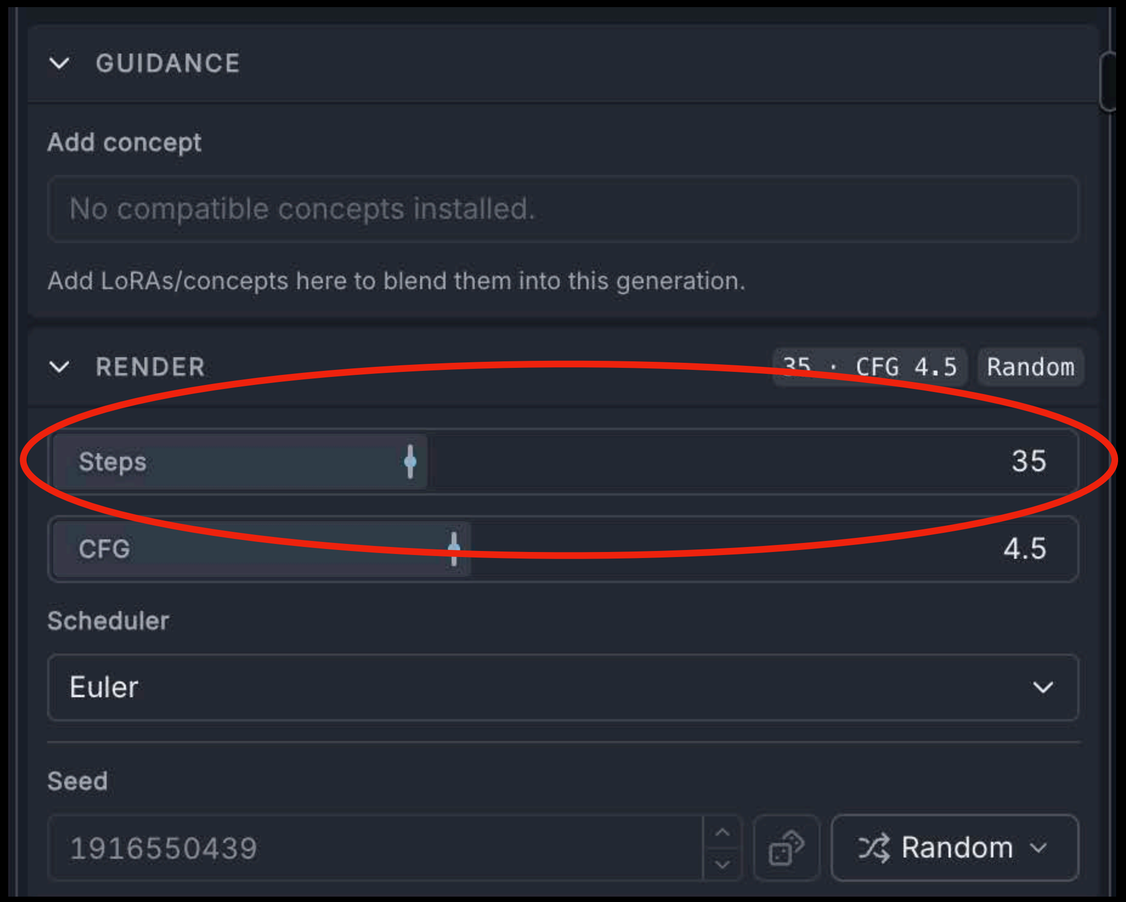
Glossary

- Latent Space
  - Where the ideas exist
  - Low resolution



Glossary

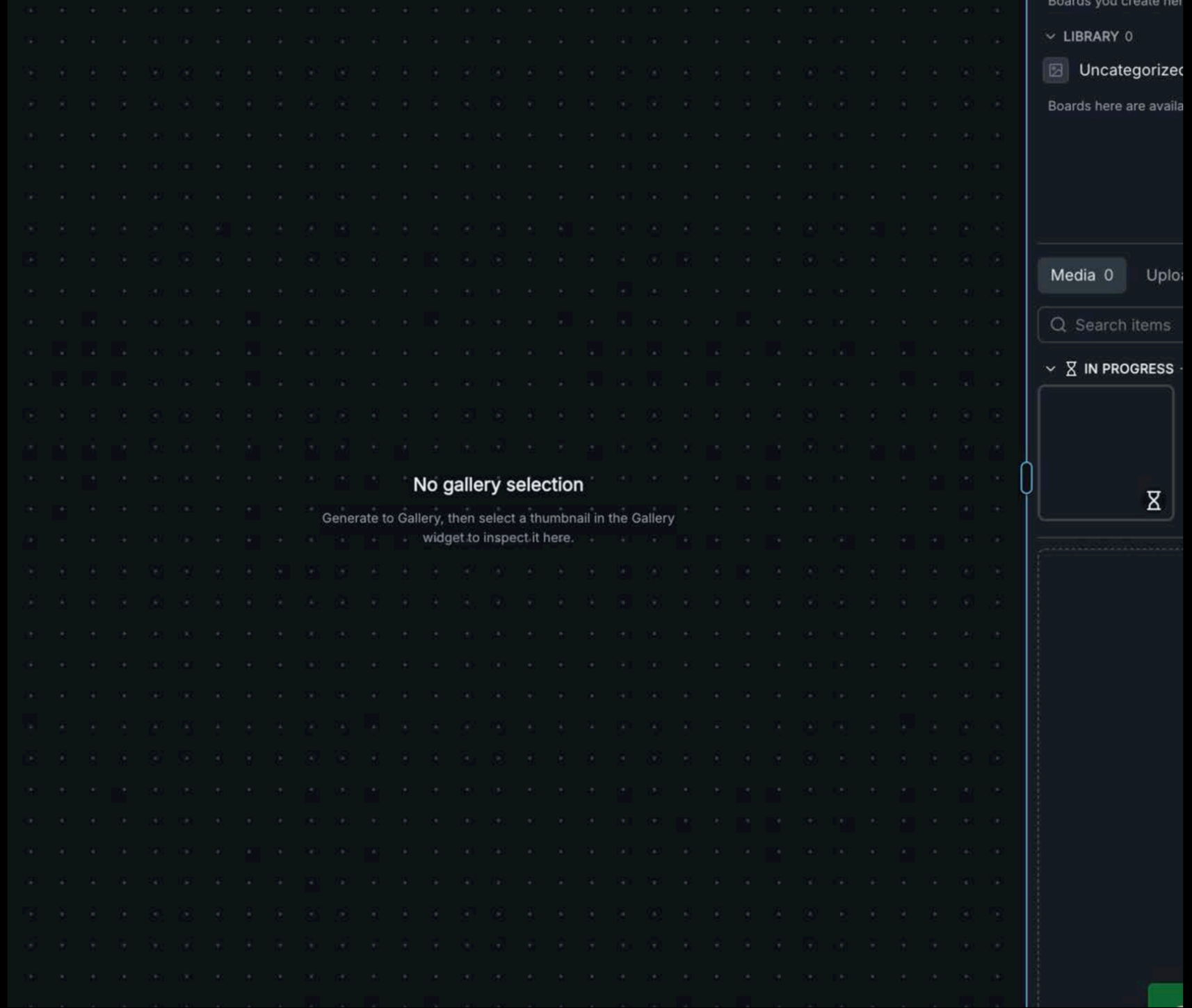
- Steps - The number of denoising steps



Steps: 1 | Steps: 2 | Steps: 3 | Steps: 5 | Steps: 8

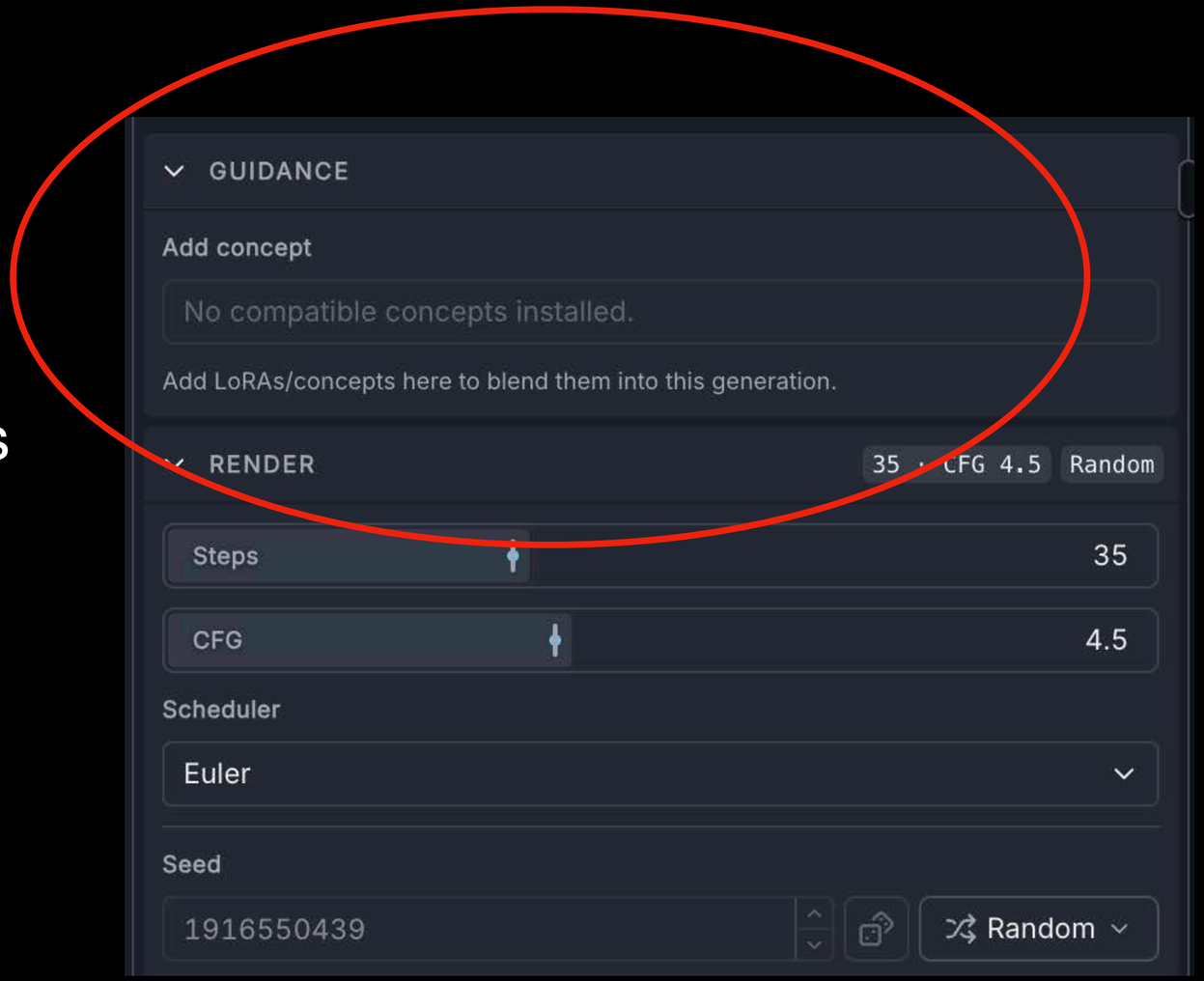


Steps: 10 | Steps: 15 | Steps: 20 | Steps: 30 | Steps: 40


No gallery selection
Generate to Gallery, then select a thumbnail in the Gallery widget to inspect it here.
LIBRARY 0
Uncategorized
Boards here are availa
Media 0
Search items
IN PROGRESS

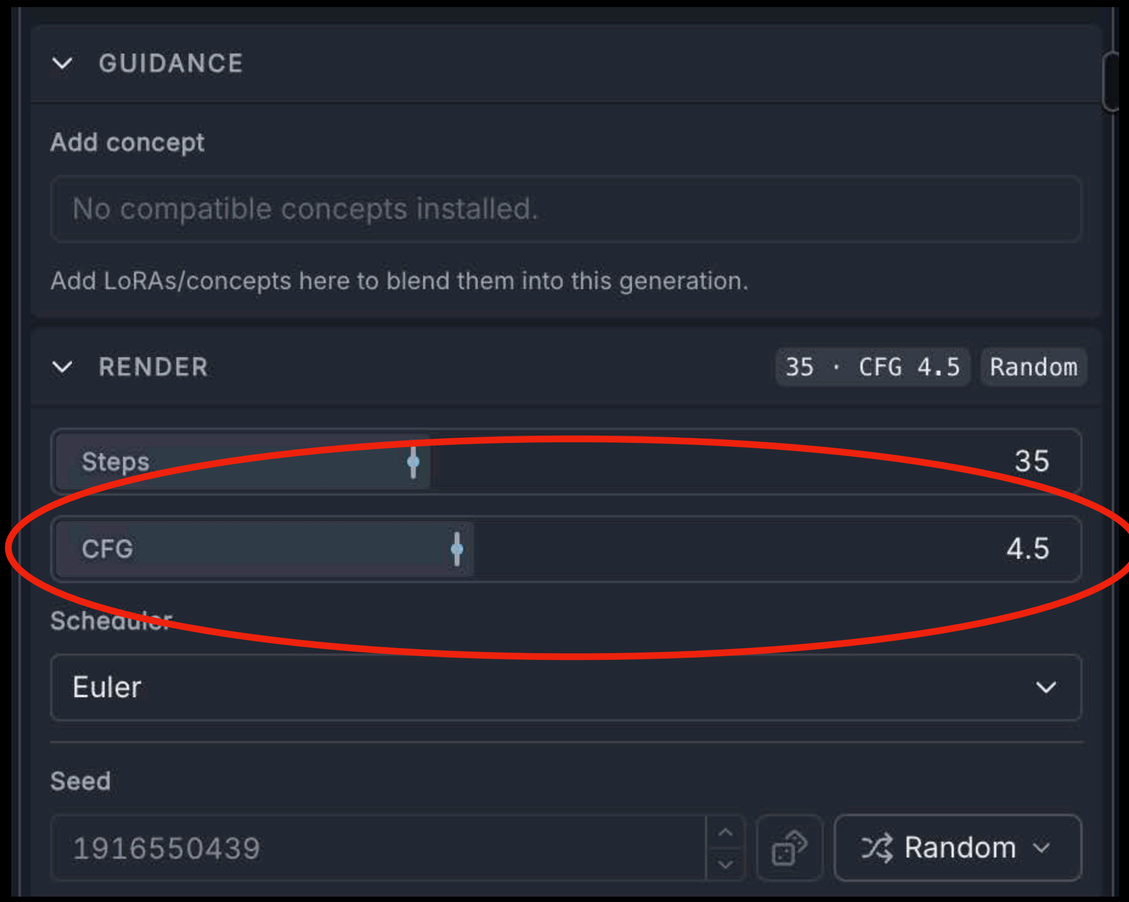
Glossary

- LoRA - A small model modifier
  - Only works with 1 base model
- Turbo model/LoRA - uses fewer steps



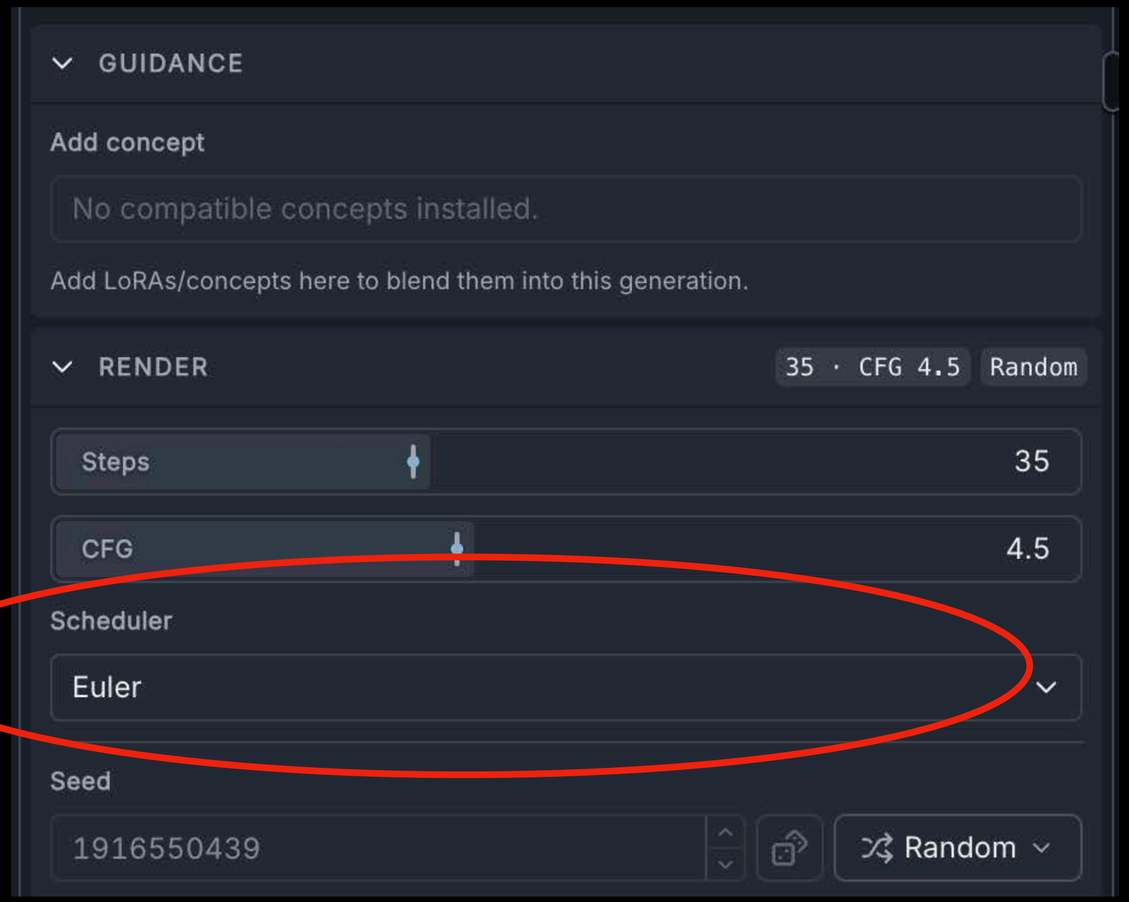
Glossary

- LoRA - A small model modifier
  - Only works with 1 base model
- Turbo model/LoRA - uses fewer steps
- CFG - How closely to follow the prompt



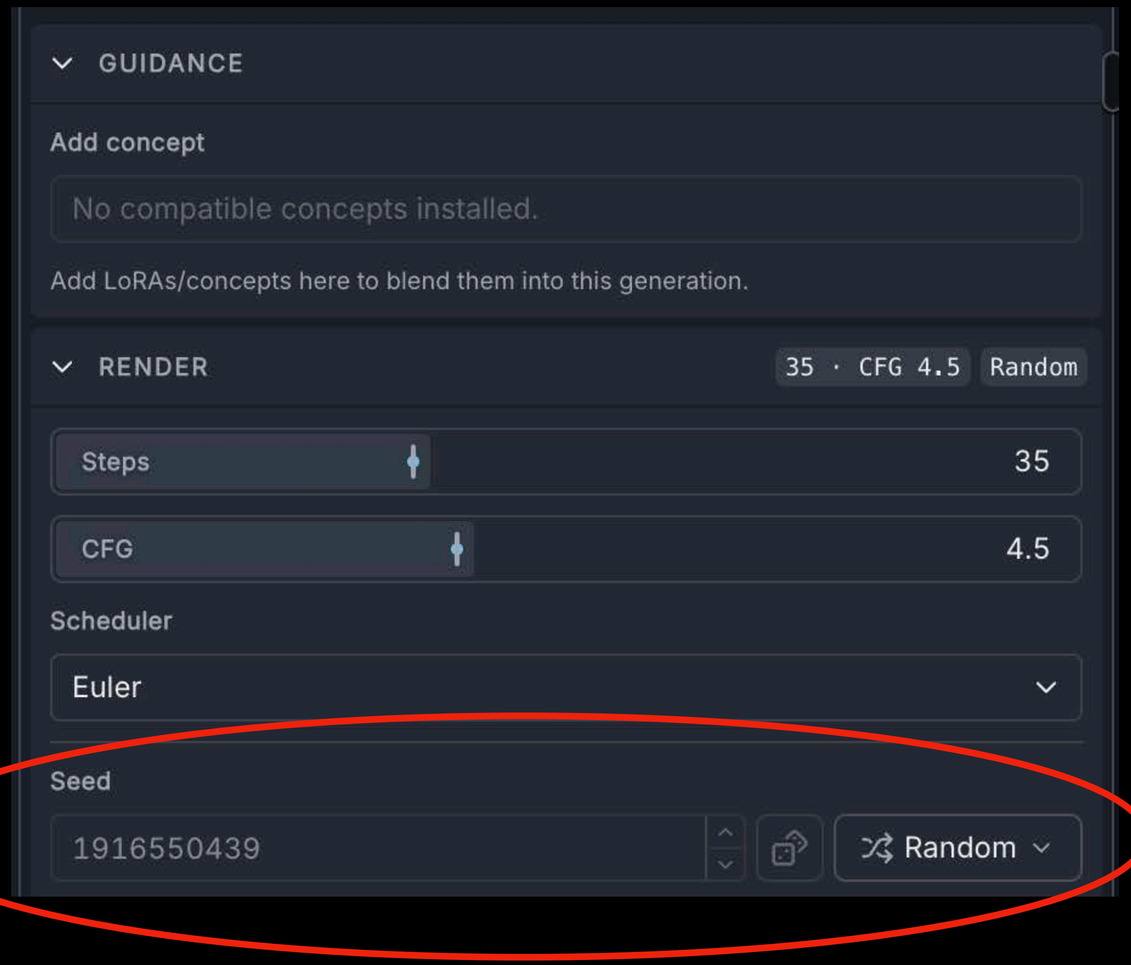
Glossary

- LoRA - A small model modifier
  - Only works with 1 base model
- Turbo model/LoRA - uses fewer steps
- CFG - How closely to follow the prompt
- Scheduler - how the model generates each step



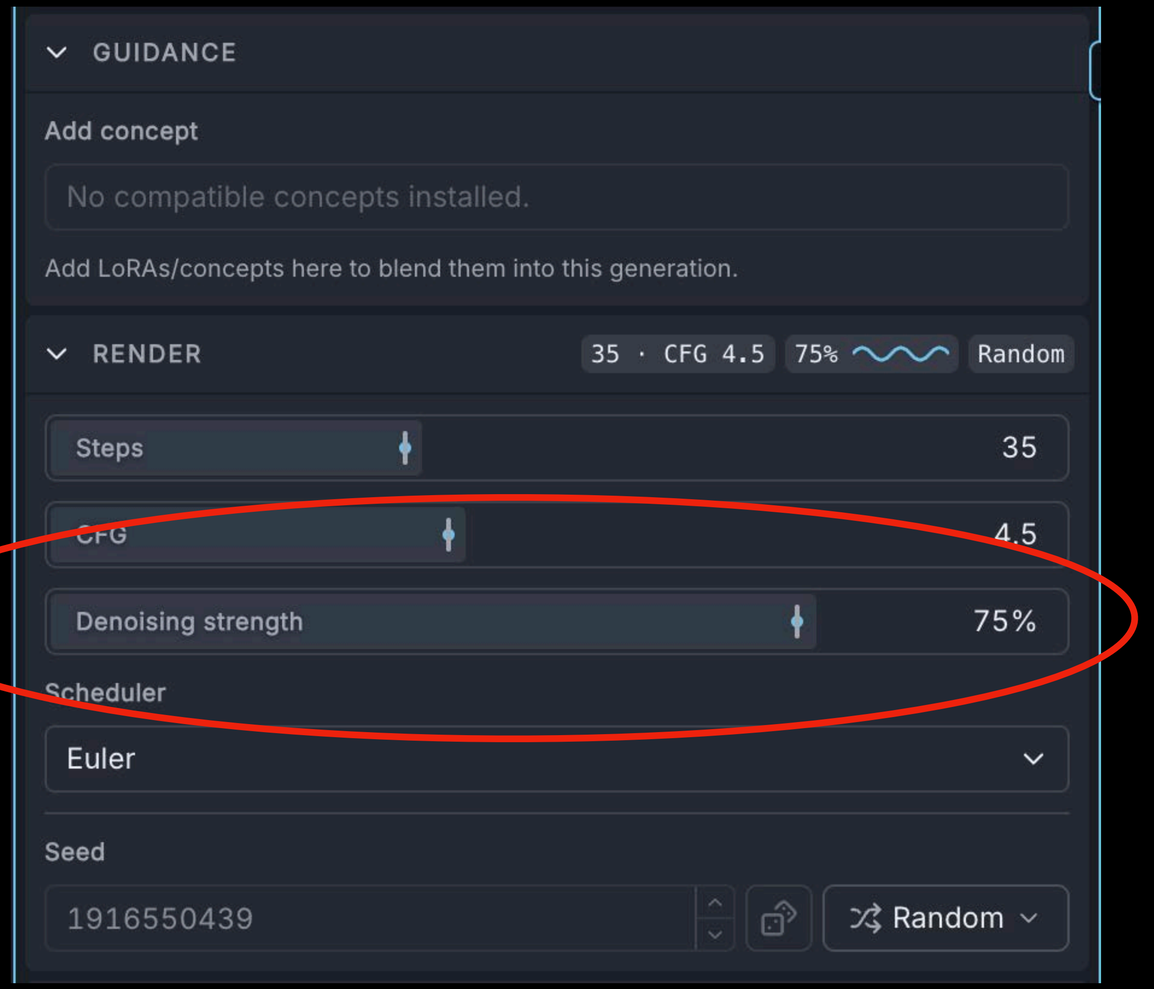
Glossary

- LoRA - A small model modifier
  - Only works with 1 base model
- Turbo model/LoRA - uses fewer steps
- CFG - How closely to follow the prompt
- Scheduler - how the model generates each step
- Seed - Same seed, same image



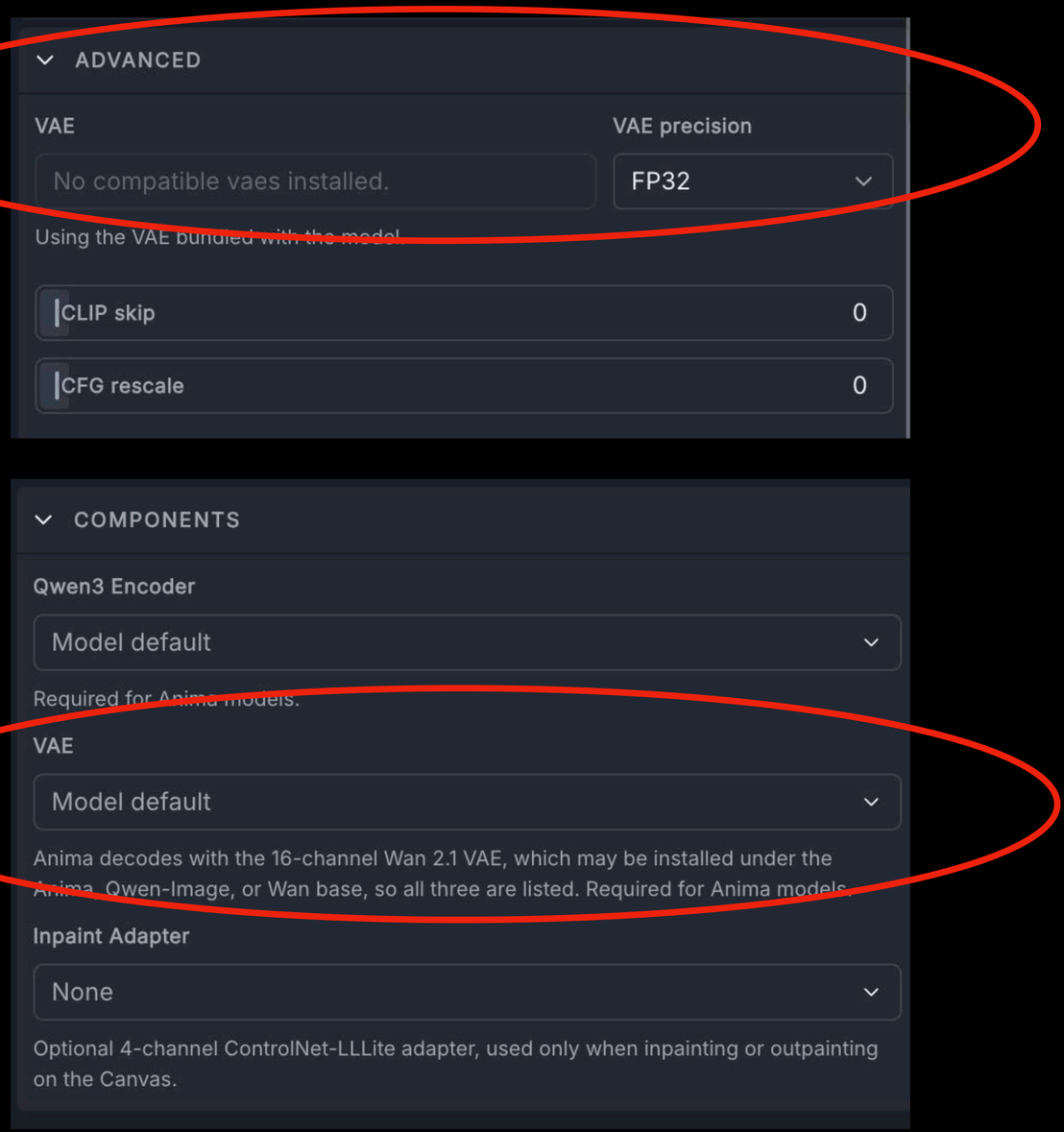
Glossary

- Denoising strength - how much to change the image (Image to image only)



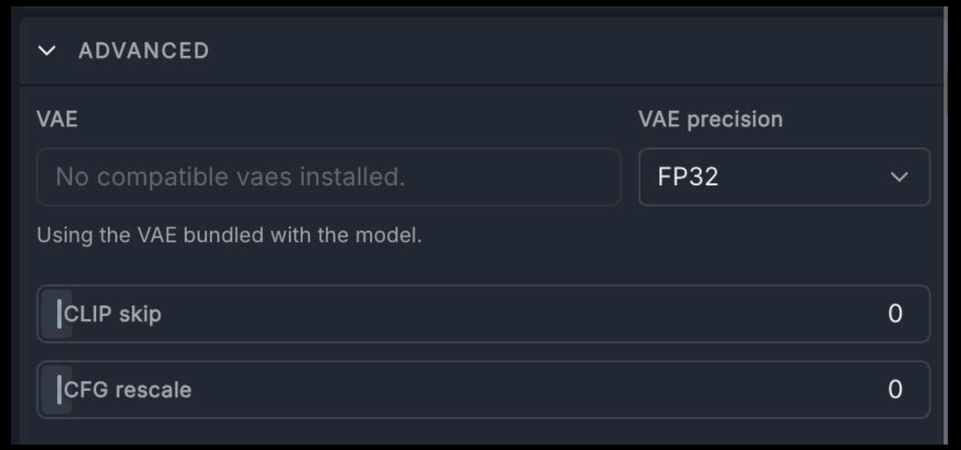
Glossary

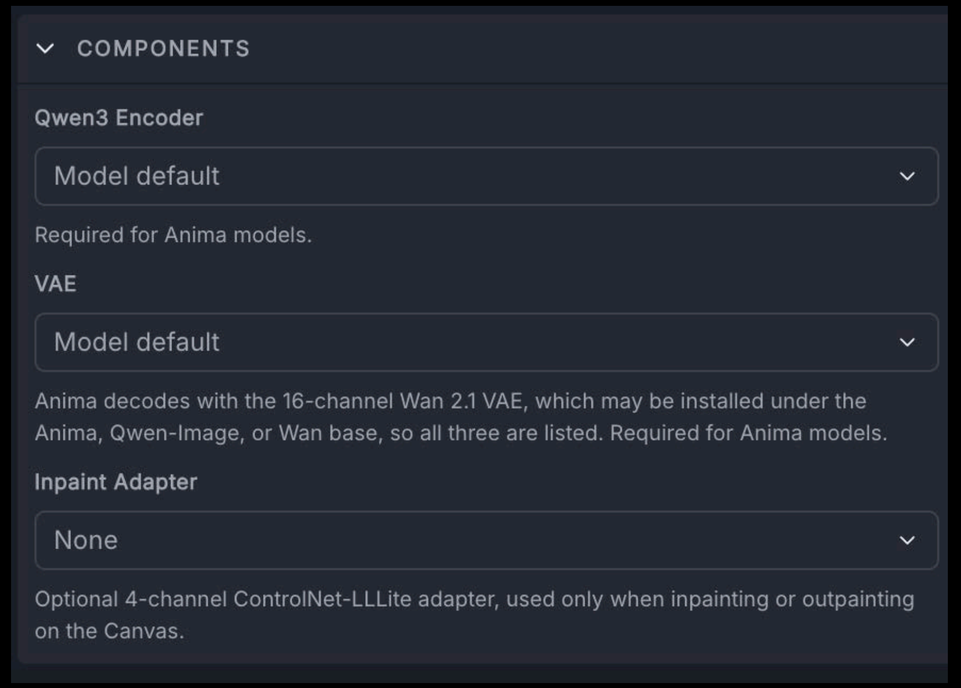
- VAE - Variational Autoencoder, converts between latent space and full image



Glossary

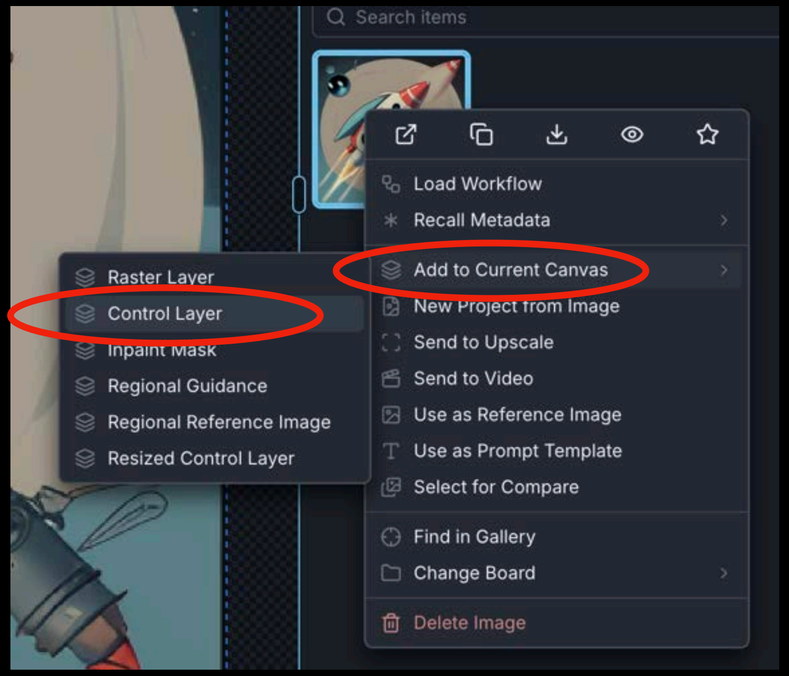
- VAE - Variational Autoencoder, converts between latent space and full image
- CLIP - Links text descriptions and visual ideas

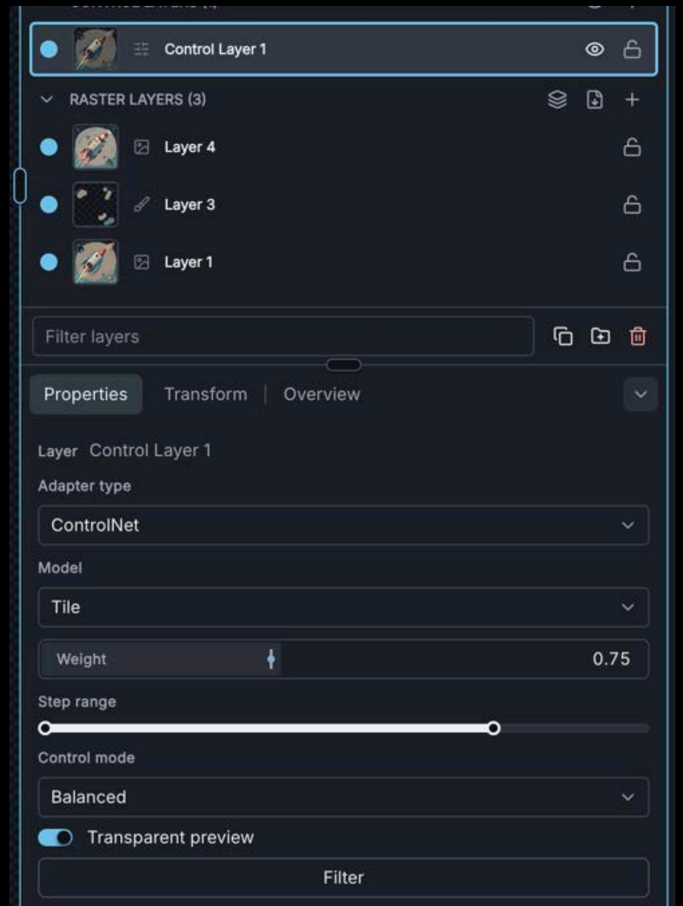


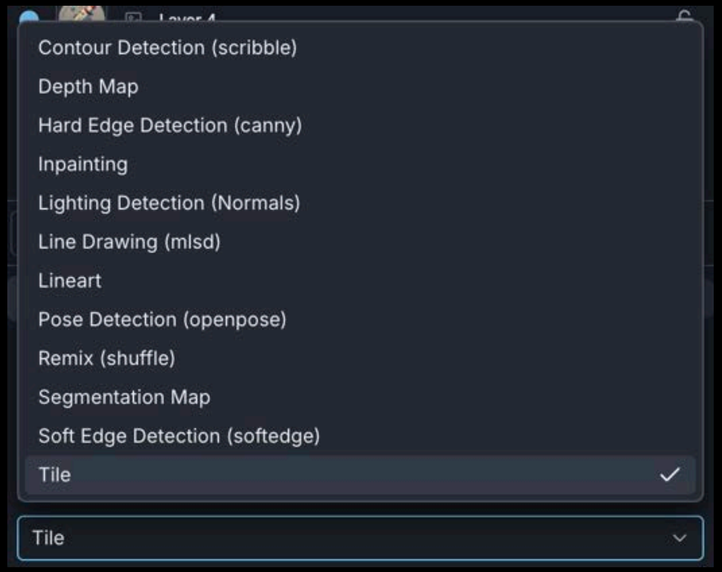


Glossary

- IP Adapter/ControlNet - Guides the image generation (not all models)







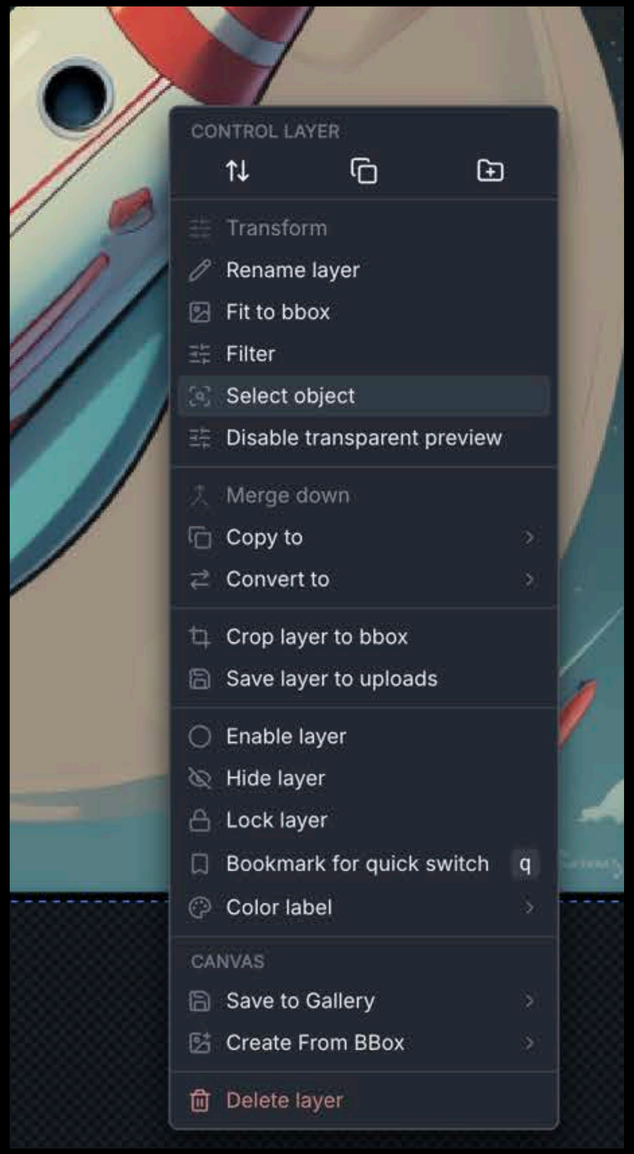
Glossary

- Canny result (this is editable)
- Depth, pose, and scribble can be created in different applications



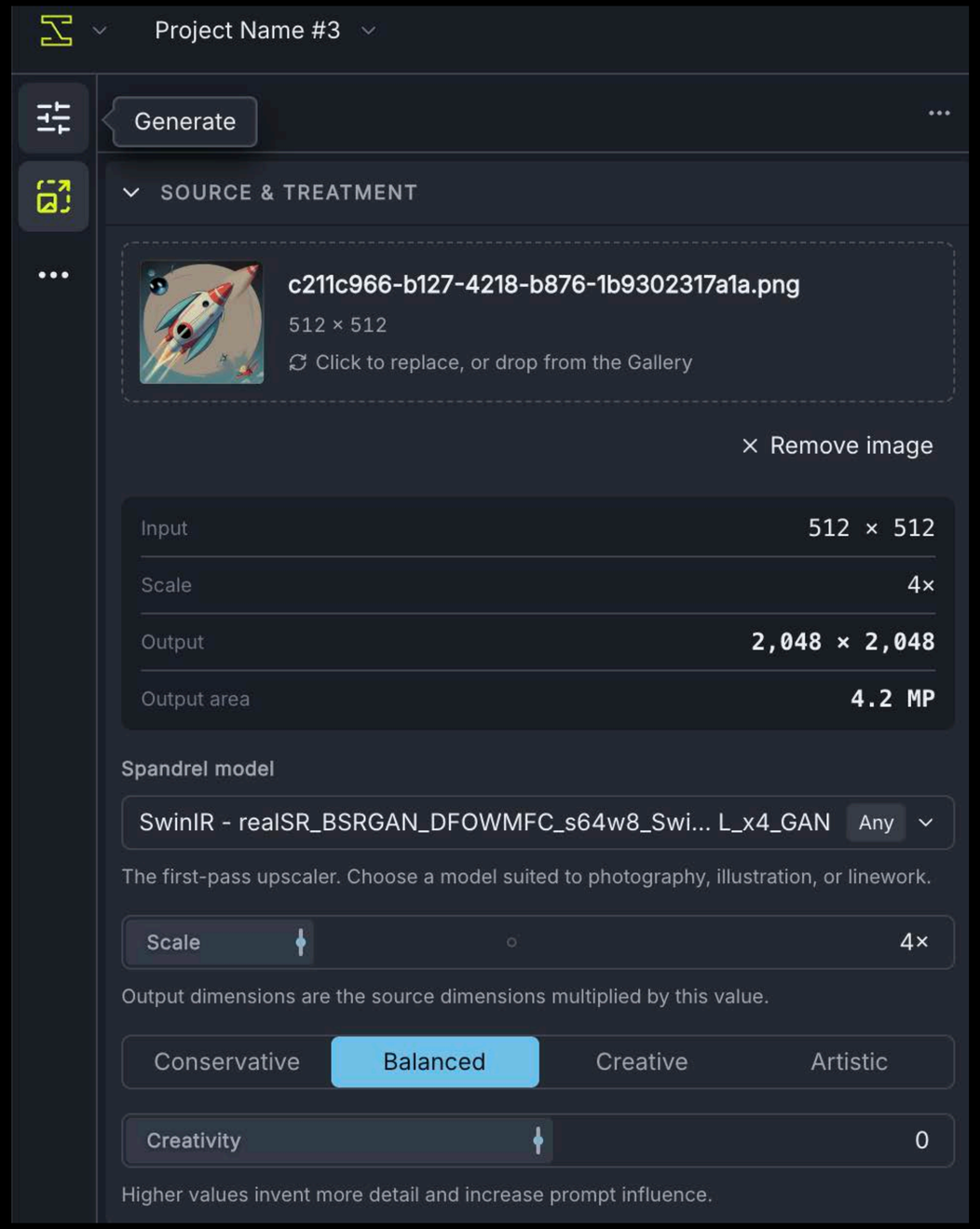
Glossary

- SAM (Segment Anything Model) Smart selection



Glossary

- GAN (Generative Adversarial Network)
  Used for upscaling



Model Families

Model Families

- SD1.5 - 2022, 512x512, 4 GB, there’s tons of models and LoRAs
- SDXL - 2023, 1024x1024, 6-8 GB
- FLUX.1 - 2024, 6–8 GB quantized; ~12 GB unquantized
- FLUX.2 - 2025, 8 GB for Klein 4B quantized, way more for the other versions
- Z-Image - 2025, 6–8 GB quantized, fast, turbo versions
- Qwen Image - 2025, ~12–16 GB, instruction following and text

Model Families

- ERNIE-Image - 2026, 24 GB,
- Anima - 2026, 6-8 GB, dedicated to anime, there’s a turbo LoRA
- Krea 2 - 2026, 8 GB for a quantized Krea 2 build
- Ideogram - 2023, typography, posters, and graphic design.
- Wan - Video, 2025, 8–12 GB for 1.3B; ~20+ GB for quantized 14B
- MiniMax H3 - Video, 2026, ?, can synchronize audio
- LTX 2.5 - Video, ?, it’s fast

Where to Get Models



CIVITAI

- CivitAI is a huge ImageGen community
- It is *the* hub for AI image models and LoRAs
- New content constantly being uploaded
- Used to host adult content but that has all moved to civitai.red

Demo